

Amendment No. 2 to SB0789

Crowe
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 789*

House Bill No. 959

by deleting SECTION 4 and substituting:

SECTION 4. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 63-22-116, is amended by deleting subsection (a) and substituting:

(a)

(1) The board may license, without examination, a professional counselor applicant with a valid, unencumbered license issued by another state, territory, or federal district of the United States at an equivalent level of licensure under the following conditions:

(A) The applicant has a sixty-hour graduate degree in counseling or a related field, meets the requirements of § 63-22-104(4)-(7), and has actively practiced without supervision at the level of licensure for which the applicant has applied for at least two (2) of the three (3) most recent years; or

(B) The applicant has a conferred graduate degree consisting of a minimum of fifty-two (52) hours in counseling or a related field from an accredited program that were earned prior to 2016, has practiced as a licensed professional counselor for a minimum of twenty-five (25) years, and meets the requirements of § 63-22-104(4)-(7).

(2) A professional counselor applicant at the highest level of licensure must meet the requirements of § 63-22-120, as well as the requirements of either subdivision (a)(1)(A) or (a)(1)(B).

SECTION 5. For the purposes of promulgating rules, this act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it. For all other purposes:

(1) Section 4 of this act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it;
and

(2) Sections 1-3 of this act take effect January 1, 2026, the public welfare requiring it.